

Operationalizing Administrative Interim Reparations for Conflict-Related Sexual Violence in Nigeria

An Empirical Call to Action for Ministry Partners, the National Human Rights Commission, and Civil Society Coalitions

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Publication Context: Executive policy brief derived from the underlying empirical assessment by Sayemo Harris (2026).	

1. Context & The Need for Administrative De-linking

Over nearly three decades of armed conflict across Northeast and North Central Nigeria, Conflict-Related Sexual Violence (CRSV) has inflicted multi-generational trauma, clinical disability, and acute economic exclusion. While security stabilization remains a national priority, survivor redress is structurally inaccessible within existing legal frameworks. Redress remains theoretically tethered to criminal convictions, yet individual perpetrators are largely unidentified, deceased, or beyond legal reach in remote enclaves. Furthermore, counter-terrorism judicial proceedings and military dockets focus strictly on state offenses without granting standing or restitution to victims. As a result, thousands of survivors receive zero urgent healthcare, fistula repair, or psychological support. **Interim Reparative Measures (IRMs)** must be established administratively to provide swift, trauma-informed redress decoupled from criminal court convictions.

2. Empirical Baseline: Documented Violations & Institutional Exposure (SVAC Data)

Actor Entity	Analytical Category	Violation Years	Peak Severity (0–3)	Child Prevalence (0–3)	Documented Active Horizon
Boko Haram (JAS)	Non-State Armed Group	13	3 (Systematic)	3 (Systematic)	2010 – 2023
ISWAP	Non-State Armed Group	6	2 (Massive)	2 (Massive)	2018 – 2023
State Armed Forces / Police	Statutory Sovereign Forces	14	3 (Systematic)	2 (Massive)	2004 – 2019
Cumulative Aggregate Profile	Cross-Conflict Horizon	33	3	3	1995 – 2023

3. Actionable Policy Pillars for Operationalization

- Pillar A: Establish a Statutory Administrative Reparations Board:** The Federal Government and subnational authorities in Borno, Yobe, and Adamawa should co-create a dedicated, non-judicial Reparations Board. Decoupled from trial verdicts, this body processes intake claims through a trauma-informed standard of administrative proof, disbursing immediate medical vouchers, mental health subsidies, and direct stabilization stipends.
- Pillar B: Implement a Decentralized, Survivor-Led Registry:** To overcome deep institutional mistrust and societal stigma, intake mechanisms must be designed and co-administered alongside local survivor networks and civil society organizations. Strict biometric, identity, and cryptographic protections must be maintained to prevent secondary trauma or exposure.
- Pillar C: Enact an Intergenerational Redress Framework for Children Born of War:** With 19 actor-years demonstrating systematic and massive targeting of children, offspring born of wartime rape face severe legal exclusion. The Ministry of Interior and National Identity Management Commission (NIMC) must establish barrier-free birth registration protocols and guaranteed schooling access to prevent multi-generational statelessness.
- Pillar D: Institute Sovereign Guarantees of Non-Recurrence:** Given that statutory armed forces account for 14 documented actor-violation years (42.4% of total recorded exposure), reparative policy must be coupled with structural security sector reform under the state's positive human rights obligations. This includes embedding enforceable CRSV accountability mechanisms into operational rules of engagement and establishing independent military human rights oversight units.

Recommended Citation: Harris, Sayemo. (2026). *Operationalizing Administrative Interim Reparations for Conflict-Related Sexual Violence in Nigeria*. Empirical Policy Assessment based on the SVAC 3.3 Dataset (PRIO/Harvard). Repository: github.com/harrissayemo-oss/crsv-nigeria-reparations-analysis